VATSIM MIAMI ARTCC

FACILITY ENGINEERING

ZMA FE DIRECTIVE 8C CHG 1

Effective: 06/19/2023

SUBJ: Ft Lauderdale ATCT SOP

This order prescribes local air traffic control procedures and phraseology for use by Ft Lauderdale Air Traffic Control Tower personnel on the VATSIM Network. This is not intended for real-world use.

In this document, routes shown in **bold** require the aircraft to be RNAV/RNP equipped and capable. For aircraft unable to accept these routings, either apply the alternative routes listed, or coordinate with the appropriate center controller to determine the most appropriate resolution.

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1. PURPOSE

This order applies to VATSIM Air Traffic Control Specialists who seek to control air traffic at the Ft Lauderdale Air Traffic Control Tower. All concerned personnel shall familiarize themselves with the provisions of this order which pertain to their operational responsibilities.

2. CANCELLATION

This document replaces and cancels ZMA Directive 8, Version B CHG 1, dated as effective on 11/15/2022.

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3. Clearance Delivery

3.1 Frequencies

3.1.1 Clearance Delivery (CD) – FLL_DEL – 128.4

3.2 General Responsibilities

3.2.1 CD controllers shall be familiar with SIDs and their groups. See Table 1 on page 4.

3.2.2 When MIA_L_DEP (Ft Lauderdale North Departure) is online, issue their frequency to all departures. Otherwise, if MIA_APP has multiple sectors open, coordinate with approach to determine which controller is working L's airspace, and issue their frequency instead.

3.2.3 Instruct all VFR departures to "maintain VFR at or below 2,500". Create a VFR flight plan including aircraft type/suffix, origin airport KFLL, direction of flight, and intended VFR cruise altitude.

3.2.4 Assign IFR turbojet departures 4,000 feet, or the requested final altitude, whichever is lower.

3.2.4.1 Assign IFR prop departures 2,000 feet.

3.2.4.2 If the requested altitude is lower than the normal initial altitude, inform the controller above you.

3.3 Preferred Routings & Altitude Constraints

3.3.1 Clear IFR departures via a current[1] RNAV SID or via the FLL# SID to the appropriate transition fix.

3.3.2 For destinations listed in Table 2, controllers shall ensure all aircraft are assigned the specified routes and altitudes (unless otherwise coordinated with the affected controllers).

3.3.3 Assign all BNICE/HROCK departures EVEN altitudes.

3.3.4 Assign all FRSBE/AGERS/LIFRR/DORRL departures ODD altitudes.

[1] For aircraft filing old SID versions, remove the SID and issue the FLL# SID.

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SID Name	Group
BNICE#	N
HROCK#	N
FRSBE#	N
AGERS#	N
LIFRR#	N
DORRL#	N
FEALX#	E
SNAPR#	S
REGAE#	S
MAYNR#	S
GLADZ#	S
FLL#	(MANY)

Table 1 – Ft Lauderdale SIDs

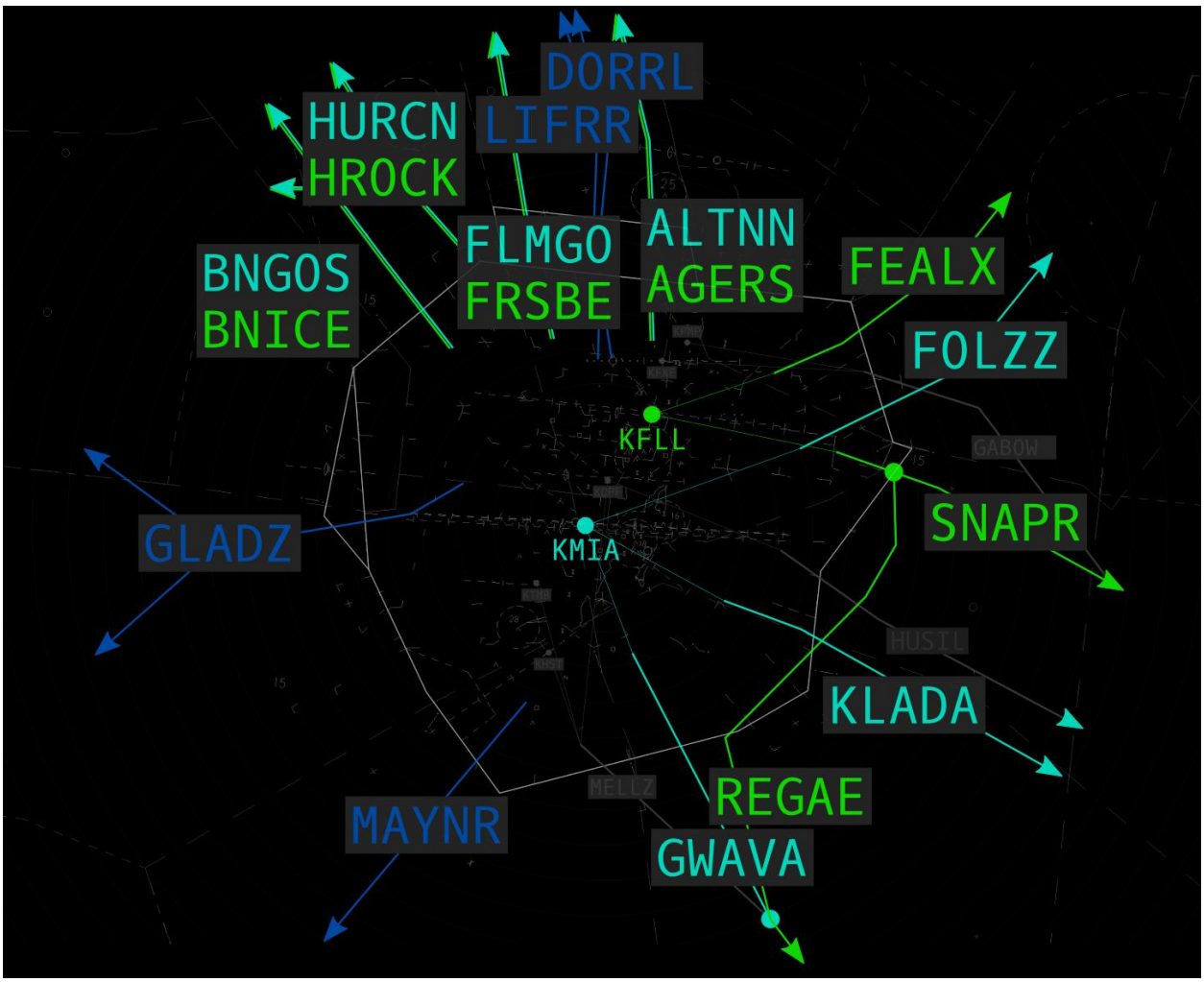

Figure 1 – MIA & FLL SID Structure

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DESTINATION	ROUTING REQUIREMENTS	ALTITUDES
TPA TRACON	**BNICE# COREA BLFRG#** FLL# BNICE LBV BRDGE# KSRQ: **BNICE# COREA** LBV V97 ROGAN DCT FLL# BNICE LBV V97 ROGAN DCT	AOB FL240
MCO TRACON	**FRSBE# WAPOM RIDES#** FLL# FRSBE PHK GOOFY# KMLB & Cape Canaveral Area: **FRSBE# WAPOM** VALKA DCT FLL# FRSBE WAPOM VALKA DCT	AOB FL230
DAB TRACON	**FRSBE# WAPOM** DIMBY T208 SMYRA DCT FLL# FRSBE WAPOM [DIMBY T208 / MLB V3] SMYRA DCT	AOB FL290
PBI TRACON	**AGERS# HURGI** PBI[2] DCT FLL# AARPS DCT KVRB/KFPR: **LIFRR# WIXED DCT** SHANC T208 CLEFF SHEDS DCT	AOB 10,000
RSW TRACON	**BNICE# MERKS** RSW[3] DCT FLL# BNICE RSW DCT	AOB 14,000
EYW TRACON	**MAYNR# MAYNR** GUCEL DCT FLL# MAYNR GUCEL DCT	AOB FL200
KJAX	**FRSBE# STYMY** ORL **HAINY QUBEN#** FRSBE STYMY ORL POGIE#	AOB FL310
KATL	**FRSBE# STYMY** Q77 SHRKS LAIRI LARZZ [JJEDI#/SIITH#] FLL# FRSBE STYMY Q77 SHRKS LAIRI LARZZ [JJEDI#/SIITH#]	---
MYNN & SATS	**SNAPR# RAJAY** ZQA[4] DCT BEECH RAJAY ZQA DCT	AOB FL230
MYGF	**FEALX# PADUS** DCT FLL# FEALX PADUS DCT	AOB 15,000
MYAM/MYAT	**FEALX# ZFP** DCT FLL# ZFP DCT	AOB FL230
KMTH	**MAYNR# MAYNR** DCT FLL# MAYNR DCT	AOB 14,000
MUHA	MUHA LANDING EAST: **MAYNR# CANOA ENTRY#** FLL# MAYNR CANOA [**ENTRY#** / AVERA#] MUHA LANDING WEST: **MAYNR# MAXIM** JUGAR# FLL# MAYNR MAXIM JUGAR#	---

Table 2 – PDARs & Altitude Constraints

[2] When destination is specifically KPBI, "PBI" may be omitted from the route (collocated with the airport).
[3] When destination is specifically KRSW, "RSW" may be omitted from the route (collocated with the airport).
[4] When destination is specifically MYNN, "ZQA" may be omitted from the route (collocated with the airport).

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4. GROUND CONTROL (GC)

4.1 FREQUENCIES

4.1.1 Ground Control North (GCN) – FLL_N_GND – 121.4 (Primary: FLL_GND)

4.1.2 Ground Control South (GCS) – FLL_S_GND – 127.5

4.1.3 Ramp Control North (RCN) – FLL_RN_GND – 118.17 (Primary: FLL_R_GND)

4.1.4 Ramp Control South (RCS) – FLL_RS_GND – 129.87

4.2 GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

4.2.1 Ensure positive separation of taxiing traffic.

4.2.2 To the extent practical, prevent any undue delay to taxiing traffic.

4.2.3 To the extent practical, sequence departing aircraft by departure gate.

4.2.4 Ensure runway exits are kept clear and arriving aircraft are moved as soon as possible to ensure all exits are available to subsequent arrivals.

4.2.5 Ensure timely transfer of communications to the subsequent GC or LC frequency such that aircraft may continue their taxi without any undue delay.

4.2.6 When operating as Ft Lauderdale Ground, do not provide ramp control services within nonmovement areas, except in a purely advisory nature. Ramp control instructions should only be given when logged on specifically as either RCN or RCS. To this effect:

4.2.6.1 Do not give arrivals taxi instructions as “taxi to the gate via”, but rather “taxi to the ramp via”.

4.2.6.2 Do not include any non-movement taxilane identifiers in taxi instructions. For example, “Runway 10L, taxi via T5-B”, not “T-T5-B”, and “taxi to the ramp via Q-N”, not “Q-N-T8”.

4.2.6.3 As necessary, you may inform aircraft where you would like them to exit the ramp prior to issuing taxi instructions, and allow them to navigate themselves there. When combined with CD, this may be done upon acknowledging the readback of a clearance.

For example, when a departure from Terminal 4 requests taxi, respond with “hold short of Q on T8 and report reaching”, or “hold short of G on N”. Or, for a departure from Terminal 1, respond with “hold short of T2 and report reaching”.

4.2.7 Do not open RCN or RCS positions unless GC services are already being provided.

4.2.8 RCN is responsible for Spot A and Spot 0 through Spot 8, Taxilane T east of Taxiway T5, gates E9 and east, and all ramps north of Taxiway A. RCS has Spot B and C, Spot 9 through Spot 13, Taxilane T at and south of Taxiway T5, Taxilane T7, Taxilane T8, Taxilane N at and south of Taxilane T7, gates E10 and south, the Zulu Ramp, and all GA ramps between the runways.

4.2.9 For GC & RC areas of responsibility, see Figure 2 on page 7.

4.3 RUNWAY CROSSING COORDINATION

4.3.1 When requesting a runway crossing from LC, specify the runway and the point at which crossing will occur, using the format of "Cross [rwy] at [intersection]?". LC's approval indicates approval for only one aircraft to cross as specified, unless "...with 2" is stated by GC and read back by LC in the original crossing request.

4.3.2 When the traffic is clear of the runway, advise LC "Runway [rwy], crossing complete".

4.3.3 LC may grant GC "crossing blankets" for individual runways, which means GC may cross those runways without coordination with LC. If GC has been granted crossing blankets, and has an aircraft who will enter and cross a runway when landing traffic is within a 2nm final for that runway, GC shall announce to LC that they are "crossing [rwy]" about 15 seconds prior to the aircraft entering the runway. GC need not obtain acknowledgement by LC.

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4.4 Preferred Taxiway Utilization

4.4.1 T7/T8/N: Use Taxiway T7 for inbounds and Taxiways T8 and N for departures.

- 4.4.1.1 Arrival 10L: via B-Q-T7
- 4.4.1.2 Arrival 10R: via H5-T8
- 4.4.1.3 Departure 10L: via N-F-L-B
- 4.4.1.4 Departure 10R: via T8-Q-J

4.4.2 Q/L: In general, Taxiway Q is preferred southbound, and Taxiway L is preferred northbound.

4.4.3 C: Taxiway C is not widely available in current sceneries. You can expect the majority of aircraft to require use of Taxiway B because they are unable Taxiway C.

4.4.4 T5: Taxiway T5 is preferred outbound in heavy traffic. In light traffic, however, it is commonly utilized in both directions.

4.5 Movement Area Taxi Restrictions

[to be completed at a later date]

4.6 Ramp Taxi Restrictions

[to be completed at a later date]

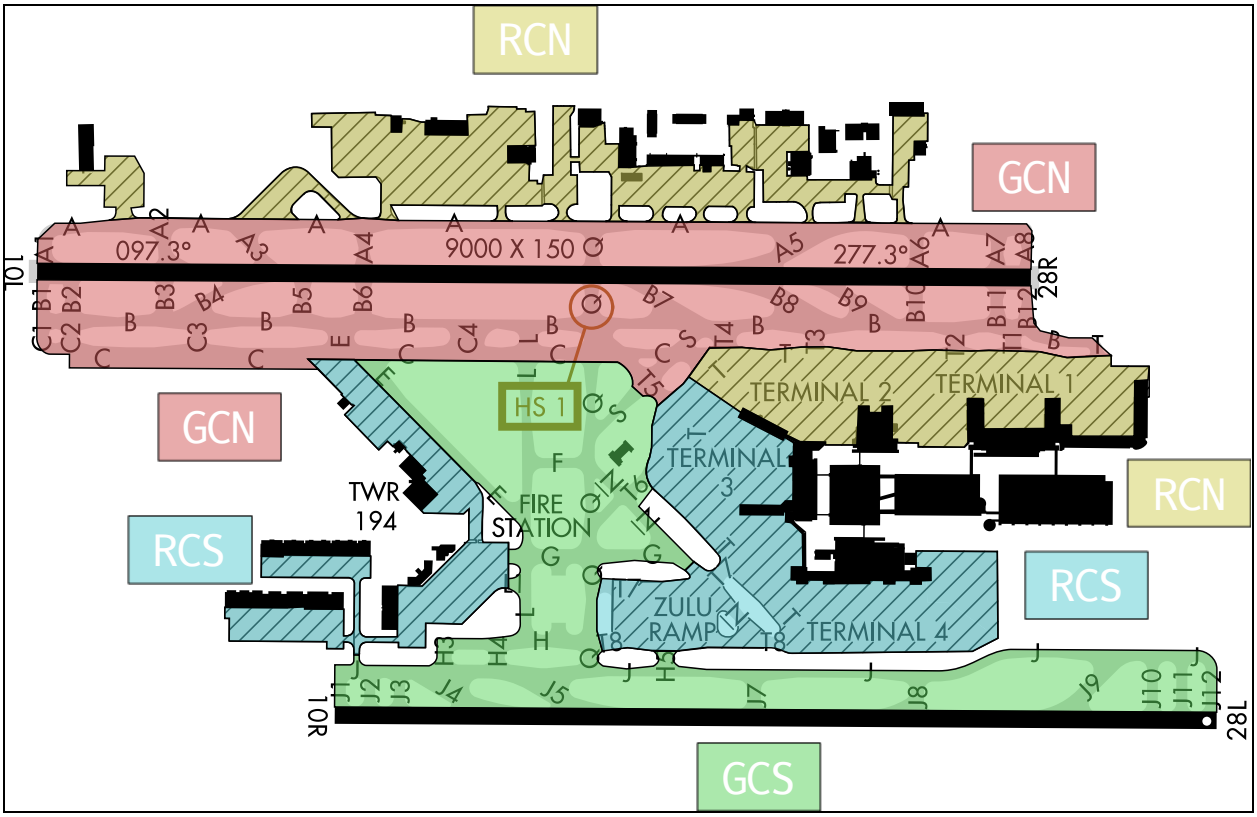

Figure 2 – Ground & Ramp Control Positions Areas of Responsibility

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5. Local Control (LC)

5.1 Frequencies

5.1.1 Local Control North (LCN) – FLL_N_TWR – 119.3 (Primary: FLL_TWR)

5.1.2 Local Control South (LCS) – FLL_S_TWR – 120.2

5.2 General Responsibilities

5.2.1 Ensure positive separation of aircraft within LC assigned airspace and movement areas.

5.2.2 Unless otherwise coordinated, LC may utilize departure headings in accordance with Table 3.

5.2.3 In the event of a missed approach or balked landing, LCN and LCS shall coordinate headings and altitudes that will ensure separation from all other known/observed traffic.

5.2.4 LC assigned airspace extends from the surface to 2,500 MSL, within the 5nm inner ring of the FLL Class C airspace, excluding the North Perry (HWO) Class D airspace.

5.3 Departure Handling

5.3.1 With all takeoff clearances on RNAV SIDs, state the first fix the aircraft should be navigating to.

"JBU123, FLL TOWER, WIND 1-1-0 at 1-5, RNAV LLBOW, RUNWAY 10L, CLEARED FOR TAKEOFF"

5.3.2 Unless otherwise coordinated, LC may utilize departure headings in accordance with Table 3 and Table 4.

5.3.2.1 When LCN and LCS are combined, all headings between the extremes of each range may be utilized by the combined LC controller.

5.3.2.2 When LCN and LCS are split, RNAV departures are not authorized due to insufficient divergence from the parallel runway, and headings must be utilized exclusively.

5.3.2.3 If assigning a heading which does not clearly differ from the RNAV departure, ensure departure control is generally aware that you are utilizing departure headings. Otherwise, no coordination with departure control is required to utilize these headings.

East Operations		
Position	**Heading**	**Blocks RNAV**
LCN	070	LLBOW
	085	[ALL]
LCS	100	MRLEE, CLPSO
LCN+LCS	070-100	N/A

Table 3 – Departure Headings (East Ops)

West Operations		
Position	**Heading**	**Blocks RNAV**
LCN	300	DREDS
	285	[ALL]
LCS	270	SEAZZ, TIDEZ
LCN+LCS	270-300	N/A

Table 4 – Departure Headings (West Ops)

5.3.3 Departure releases are automatic, with the sole exceptions being the following:

5.3.3.1 LCS shall APREQ all departures with LCN (except pattern traffic on the south runway).

5.3.4 To request a departure release, state the word "REQUEST", followed by the SID/VDF. As appropriate, use the word "PROP", "HEAVY" or "SUPER".

"REQUEST PROP BNGOS" [...] "RELEASED" or "RELEASED BEHIND [CALLSIGN]" or "STAND BY"

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5.4 VFR HANDLING

5.4.1 For airborne VFR overflight aircraft transitioning FLL Charlie airspace north/south, assign:

5.4.1.1 Northbound: Ft Lauderdale Overhead Transition at 2,500.

5.4.1.2 Southbound: Ft Lauderdale Overhead Transition to the Red Road Transition at 2,500. Transfer communications with the aircraft to the appropriate approach control frequency[5] immediately upon passing the south runway. Expect the approach controller to issue a climb into Class B at 3,500.[6]

5.4.2 For VFR aircraft destined for KMIA, assign:

5.4.2.1 East Ops: Join shoreline southbound at 1,400. At Haulover Inlet, slight right, and follow the bay.[7] Transfer communications to MIA TWR upon observing the turn into Biscayne Bay.

5.4.2.2 West: Red Road Transition at 2,500.
Transfer communications to HWO TWR immediately upon observing the southbound turn.

5.5 RUNWAY USAGE

5.5.1 Unless the forecast indicates an imminent change, in wind less than 5 knots, east operations shall be conducted (landing and departing 10L/10R).

5.6 RADAR TOWER FUNCTIONS

5.6.1 Only controllers holding S3 certifications may perform radar tower functions at KFLL.

5.6.2 Except as described below, Local Control may provide complete radar services, including radar identifying, tracking, initiating radar handoffs and point outs, clock/distance based traffic information, and (to a limited extent[8]) radar vectors.

5.6.2.1 Only start a track for aircraft which you have properly established positive radar identification, and called the aircraft "radar contact". If they descend below radar coverage, they will need to be re-identified. For this reason, it is not appropriate to track aircraft remaining in the traffic pattern.

5.6.2.2 Do not track IFR aircraft, except IFR overflights through LC assigned airspace.

5.6.2.3 Do not issue any approach clearances.

[5] When Miami Approach is offline, LC shall retain communications with the aircraft and issue a clearance through Miami Bravo airspace via the Red Road Transition, instructing the aircraft to climb to maintain VFR at 3,500.
[6] This will necessitate a point out to HWO TWR.
[7] This will necessitate a point out to North Satellite (Q).
[8] Aircraft should only be vectored for sequencing or separation. For example, vectoring for traffic is acceptable, while vectoring for an approach, or in the traffic pattern, would not be acceptable.

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